

In short, wildcards let us build powerful search engines into the applications that drive our results. SQL accepts two LIKE operators, they are:

| SR.NO. | WILDCARD & DESCRIPTION                                                                                                                                                                         |
|--------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1      | <p>The percent sign (%)</p> <p>Matches one or more characters.</p> <p><i>Note - MS Access uses the asterisk (*) wildcard character instead of the percent sign (%) wildcard character.</i></p> |
| 2      | <p>The underscore (_)</p> <p>Matches one character.</p> <p><i>Note - MS Access uses a question mark (?) instead of the underscore (_) to match any one character.</i></p>                      |

The basic syntax of a '%' and a '\_' operator is as follows.

```
SELECT FROM table_name
WHERE column LIKE 'XXXX%'
```

or

```
SELECT FROM table_name
WHERE column LIKE '%XXXX'
```

or

```
SELECT FROM table_name
WHERE column LIKE 'XXXX_'
```

or

```
SELECT FROM table_name
WHERE column LIKE '_XXXX'
```

or

```
SELECT FROM table_name
WHERE column LIKE '_XXXX_'
```

Expression- A character expression such as a column or field.

Pattern- A character expression that contains pattern matching

escape\_character - Optional. It allows you to test for literal instances of a wildcard character such as % or \_. If you do not provide the escape\_character, MySQL assumes that “\” is the escape\_character.

## % of the percentage

A sequence of zero (0) or more is used with a percentage character to indicate it.

```
SELECT statements... WHERE fieldname LIKE 'xxx%';
```

The basic SQL SELECT instruction is “SELECT statement....”. The keyword used for the filter is “WHERE.” “LIKE” is the comparison operator used in